

FirePro new launch

AMD has just launched its latest series of FirePro graphics card – the AMD FirePro V7900 SDI and a FirePro SDI-Link

Nvidia gaming event

Nvidia is organising a LAN gaming tournament in Mumbai on October 14th <http://bit.ly/r275YG>

for ZOTAC GTX 560Ti's good performance goes to the almost 130 MHz of overclock which was 50 MHz higher than the factory overclock of the EVGA GTX 560 Ti. This performance, however, comes at a cost. The load temperature on the ZOTAC GTX 560 Ti AMP Edition was touching 95 degrees

weapons guide, etc related to the game. In addition to this, you get a mouse pad with the *Duke Nukem* logo and a belt buckle. The card is at stock settings though.

Asus has around three cards here: ENGTX 560, EAH 6870 and EAH 6850. The HD 6850 is overclocked by a mere 15 MHz and along with

barring Asus EAH 6850, all other cards give equivalent scores at 1920x1080 resolution.

Crysis Warhead is still a tough game to conquer by this category of cards as compared to *Crysis 2* as is seen in the scores. In *Crysis Warhead* the maximum frame-rate at 1920x1080 was around 31 fps achieved by ZOTAC and EVGA GTX 560s; whereas in *Crysis 2*, at the same resolution and Hardcore setting, the EVGA GTX 560 scored 55 FPS.

The importance of heat pipes touching the GPU to dissipate heat is quite evident in the load temperature readings of HIS HD 6870 IceQX and Asus ENGTX 460. The load temperatures never crossed 52 degrees Celcius for these cards, with the HIS giving a temperature delta (Delta = Load temp - Idle temp) of just 25 degrees. The ZOTAC GTX 560 on the other hand touches 79 degrees Celcius with a temperature delta of almost 50 degrees. Asus EAH6870 which doesn't have heat pipes also gives a temperature delta of 39 degrees which is considerably higher than that of ENGTX 460.

a mere 10 MHz overclocked. It really surprises us as to why Asus has such minutely factory overclocked editions, which barely make any substantial difference in the frame-rates as compared to the 50MHz or 100MHz overclocks.

MSI N550GTX Ti and R6850 are both Cyclone editions which means that they're factory overclocked. The heat sink and fan design is quite impressive on the Cyclone cards. Well, there's a passive heatsink which extends in a circular manner around the fan. Two heat pipes go on either side of the heat sink, and there's designer metal on top of the heatsink with the MSI branding.

EVGA GTX 465 bundles in an HDMI cable as well – quite rare with graphics cards. Sapphire HD 6770 bundles in a



ZOTAC GTX 560Ti AMP Edition

C which also happens to be the hottest temperatures reached by any card in this comparison test. Also noise is quite audible in the ZOTAC card as compared to other cards.

MSI GTX 560 was the coolest card, with load temperatures under 50 degrees. HIS HD 6950 performed considerably lower in *Dirt 3* at all test settings whereas in *STALKER: Call of Pripyat*, *Crysis Warhead* and *Crysis 2*, it came in as the third highest. In *FarCry2* the factory overclocked Asus GTX 560 trumped the HIS HD 6950.

From ₹10K to ₹12K

In this category which is just above ₹10,000 there were around six cards. The card that stood out here was the EVGA GTX 560: *Duke's Fully Loaded Package*. The packaging was bulky with the *Duke Nukem Forever* logos all around. It houses the *Duke Nukem Forever* gaming CD, a *Duke Nukem Forever: Balls of Steel Limited Edition* guide which has all the artwork, history,

the ENGTX 460 comes the DirectCU name tag. It implies that the card has three copper heat pipes which are in direct contact with the GPU helping in dissipating heat faster. The EAH6870 is very similar to the reference AMD design.

ZOTAC GTX 560 is a no-frills card whose design is similar to the GTX 560 Ti which has a race-car like appeal with grilled metal being held in place by a solid outer chassis.

HIS HD 6870 IceQX has an aqua blue shroud covering the heat sink along with a honeycomb design around the fan. This is a welcome change from the dark-coloured shrouds we're used to. To further help in heat dissipation, there are four heat pipes touching the GPU. The packaging also lays a lot of stress on the "Cool n Quiet" attribute.

Performance

ZOTAC GTX 560 tends to lead in most of the gaming benchmarks closely followed by EVGA GTX 560. In *STALKER: Call of Pripyat*,



HIS HD 6870 IceQX

coupon code for downloading *Dirt 3*.

Asus GTX 550 Ti comes with the Direct CU branding. ZOTAC GTX 550Ti and the GTX 550Ti AMP Edition have the same design as the GTX 560Ti. It does get a little boring to see the same design all the time though.

Performance

The MSI R6850 and EVGA GTX 465 are the two cards which have a performance advantage thanks to higher number of stream processors on both of them, as compared to the HD 67xx series and GTX 550Ti's. The HD 6850 has double the memory inter-